

Decision-making guide

Consumer Behavior

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1. Simulation platform introduction

1.1 Game Arena

GAME ARENA READING FORUM LEADERBOARD

Introduction Market Information Search Target Conceptualizing Crafting Decision Checklist Report Synopsis



How does it work?



Market

The gaming world is evolving, and you must identify emerging needs. Dive into market reports to discern the crucial gaps in the market. Amidst varying trends and demands, decide on a specific genre or demographic to focus on.



Information Search

Armed with information about the market, you must embark on a fact-finding mission. But beware! Information can sometimes be misleading or contradictory, requiring you to judiciously discern key gamer desires.



Target

With insights in hand, decide the demographics, and who would be the main user of your game. The demographics have to be as detailed as possible taking into account the language, gender, and income.



Conceptualizing

It's time to brainstorm game concepts. Weigh the pros and cons of different genres, situational elements, cultural elements, and lifestyle elements. The choices made here will set the stage for the game's potential success or failure.



Crafting

Dive deep into the game launch process. Decide which channels you want to use to promote the game. You must choose a partner to publish the game or do it by your own. Create your revenue model.



Reports

The game hits the market, and it's time for a post-mortem. Analyze based on your decision-making how much market share you are able to achieve and how many paying customers.

The gaming arena interface comprises various decision tabs, each categorized into market, location, demand, investment, marketing, Decision Checklist, Report, and Synopsis. Some sections must be completed first as they have an impact on other areas.

There are two primary types of input fields:

1. Decision cells: These can manifest as light blue input cells, checkboxes, or radio buttons.
2. Estimation cells: The demand forecast allows you to input estimations that serve as the foundation for the system's cost budgeting.

1.2 Readings

GAME ARENA READING FORUM

Introduction Market Information Search Target Conceptualizing Crafting Decision Checklist Report Synopsis

Reading

Materials from Instructor

Game Instructions

Decision-making instruction

Decision-making process to introduced in the document step-by-step

[Read](#)

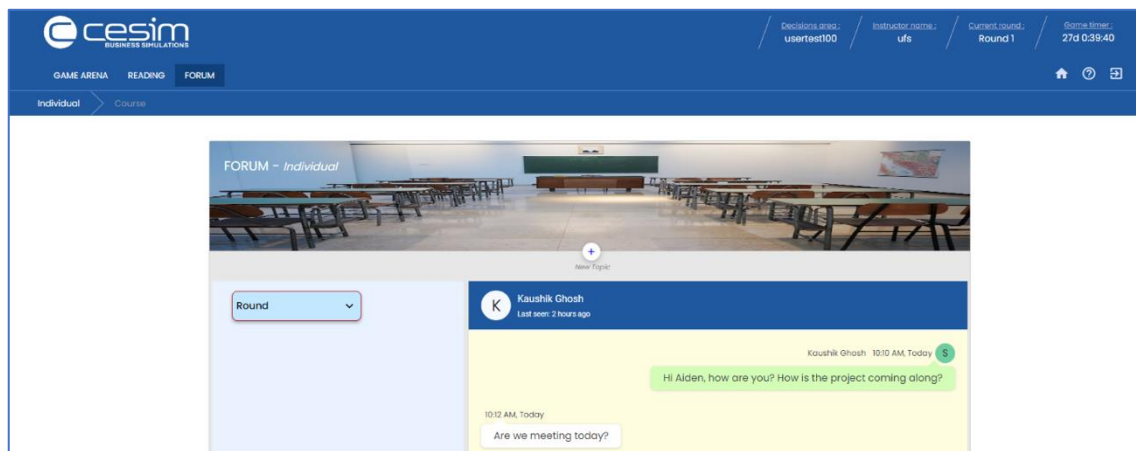
Walkthrough Video

A Tutorial on making step-by-step decisions

[View](#)

This section offers crucial materials that participants need to go through for active participation in the game. The primary reading material includes a decision-making guide. Instructors can choose to enhance these resources with additional materials. Additionally, there is a walkthrough video available, providing comprehensive details about the business scenario covered in the course. This video offers insights into the company, its industry, current trends, challenges, and the various decisions that need to be made.

1.3 Forum



- The forums provide an excellent platform for participants to engage with their instructors or peers.
- There are two separate forums: the Individual Forum and the Course Forum. The Individual Forum allows participants to communicate directly with the instructor, while the Course Forum is accessible to all enrolled players.
- Instructors can view and respond to posts in both sections. Consequently, the Course Forum is an appropriate space for asking questions that can benefit the entire course, while the Individual Forum is the preferred channel for the individual to have a direct discussion with the professor.
- Participants will receive notifications for messages.

1.4 Main Objective & Winning Criteria

The main objective of the simulation is to develop a successful mobile game that resonates with the target audience, thereby enabling the gaming company to achieve a market share of over 7% and attract paying consumers in the competitive mobile gaming landscape.

The winning criteria for the simulation are twofold:

1. **Market Share Achievement:** The simulation participants must develop a mobile game that captures a market share of over 7% within the competitive mobile gaming landscape. This metric signifies the effectiveness of the game in attracting and retaining consumers amidst fierce competition.
2. **Paying Consumer Attraction:** The mobile game should successfully attract paying consumers, indicating its value proposition and monetization potential. This criterion reflects the ability of the game to generate revenue and sustain profitability in the long term.

1.5 Successful decision-making flow

The sequence of decision-making unfolds as follows:



2. Game Arena

The major sections under the game arena includes:

- a. **Introduction:** This section provides an overview of how the entire simulation works and the steps to follow.

How does it work?

Market

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Information Search

Armed with information about the market, you must embark on a fact-finding mission. But beware! Information can sometimes be misleading or contradictory, requiring you to judiciously discern key gamer desires.

Target

With insights in hand, decide the demographics, and who would be the main user of your game. The demographics have to be as detailed as possible taking into account the language, gender, and income.

- b. **Market:** Serving as a critical section, it functions as a vital repository of details, providing insights into the company's objectives, strategic methodology, and the dynamic trends in the market.

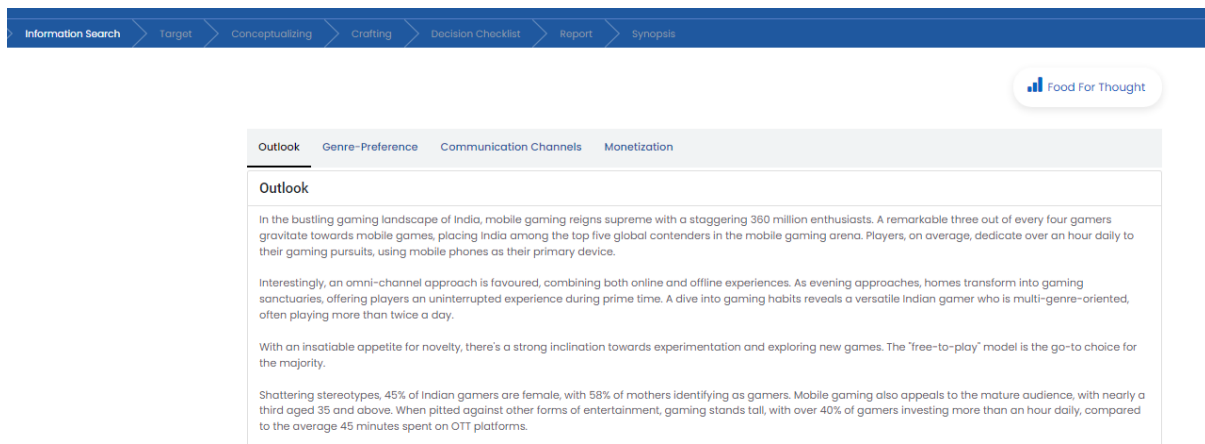
Market

In the dynamic realm of electronic gaming, the industry's revenue now surpasses that of the film industry, establishing itself as a prominent global leisure activity. Categorized into online and mobile games, console and PC gaming, internet-delivered games, and serious games, the diversity in preferences highlights the importance of understanding the factors influencing gamers' choices.

With the widespread use of smartphones transforming gaming experiences, Nero Gaming, a passionate developer, is poised to enter the burgeoning Indian market with its debut mobile game. The company aims to grasp the intricacies of Indian mobile gamers' behavior, encompassing both play and payment patterns. To achieve this, the responsibility of exploring consumer behavior models and providing valuable insights has been assigned.

Navigating the intricate gaming ecosystem involving developers, publishers, and ad networks, Nero adopts a distinctive strategy in the competitive market. With an ambitious goal of capturing a market share exceeding 7% in the initial year, they aim to redefine the gaming landscape for their audience. Backed by substantial commitment, including a revenue of USD 240K, an 8 to 12-month game development timeline, and a significant marketing budget of USD 100K, Nero remains undeterred in its pursuit of making a substantial impact in the Indian mobile gaming market, despite the typical 2 to 5-year journey to breakeven.

- c. **Information Search:** Within this section, participants access a comprehensive market report offering invaluable insights into market dynamics.



Information Search > Target > Conceptualizing > Crafting > Decision Checklist > Report > Synopsis

Food For Thought

Outlook Genre-Preference Communication Channels Monetization

Outlook

In the bustling gaming landscape of India, mobile gaming reigns supreme with a staggering 360 million enthusiasts. A remarkable three out of every four gamers gravitate towards mobile games, placing India among the top five global contenders in the mobile gaming arena. Players, on average, dedicate over an hour daily to their gaming pursuits, using mobile phones as their primary device.

Interestingly, an omni-channel approach is favoured, combining both online and offline experiences. As evening approaches, homes transform into gaming sanctuaries, offering players an uninterrupted experience during prime time. A dive into gaming habits reveals a versatile Indian gamer who is multi-genre-oriented, often playing more than twice a day.

With an insatiable appetite for novelty, there's a strong inclination towards experimentation and exploring new games. The "free-to-play" model is the go-to choice for the majority.

Shattering stereotypes, 45% of Indian gamers are female, with 58% of mothers identifying as gamers. Mobile gaming also appeals to the mature audience, with nearly a third aged 35 and above. When pitted against other forms of entertainment, gaming stands tall, with over 40% of gamers investing more than an hour daily, compared to the average 45 minutes spent on OTT platforms.

- d. **Target:** In this section, participants make decisions on the target market.
- e. **Conceptualizing:** In this section, participants make decisions that aim at designing the product with suitable situational and lifestyle elements.
- f. **Crafting:** In this section, participants make decisions on how to reach the target audience by crafting communication strategy and monetization decisions.
- g. **Decision Checklist:** In this section, participants have the opportunity to review the decisions and submit the decisions.
- h. **Report:** This section contains the results of the simulation.
- i. **Synopsis:** Contains the summary of the decisions took by the participant for the round.

2.1 Stage I – Target Market

Participants need to make decisions concerning the target market, considering aspects like demographics, language preferences, and income. Considerations should take into account population size, financial capacity, and insights derived from market research. The decision lies in choosing between a broad approach targeting a larger audience with lower financial capacity or a more focused strategy targeting a specific market with higher paying customers.

a. Demographic

The various decision under demographic includes decision on the age group, gamers population between metro or non-metro, and the population division.



Figure representing Target Market Demographics Decision area in the simulation

b. Language

Participant can choose multiple languages (up to 4) in the mobile game to attract consumers and enhance user understanding or comprehension as well as making the proposition more attractive to the customers. Consider the population indication provided in the graph and align it with the chosen target market strategy.

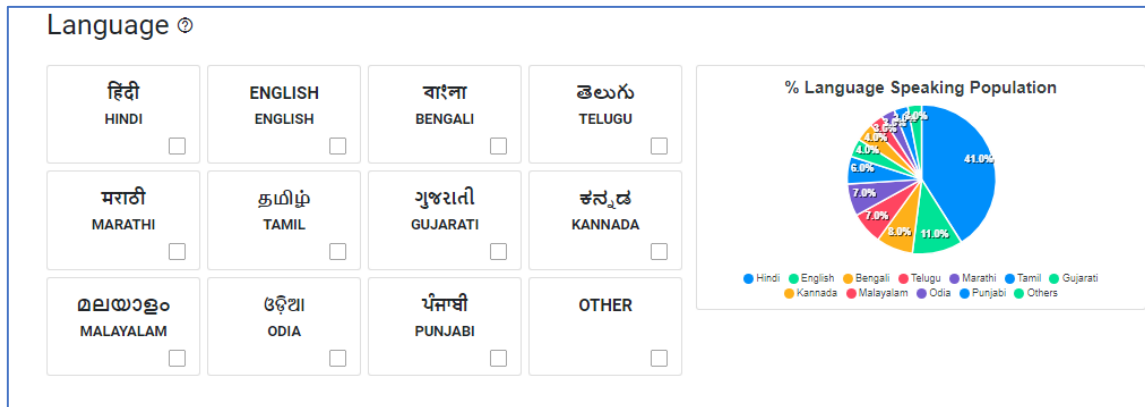


Figure representing Target Market Language Decision area in the simulation

c. Income

Participants have the option to concentrate on a particular target market using the NCCS classification data given where NCCS stands for New Consumer Classification System that is used to classify households in India based on two variables such as educational qualification of the CWE (Chief Wage Earner) and number of households possessed from a predefined list. The available choices include NCCS A, NCCS B, and NCCS C/D/E categories, each with varying paying capacities C/D/E represents the mass market segment. If the aim is to enhance the customer segment through mass marketing, one can opt for the NCCS C/D/E category. On the other hand, selecting NCCS A or NCCS B targets may result in a higher number of paying consumers but a potentially smaller customer segment.

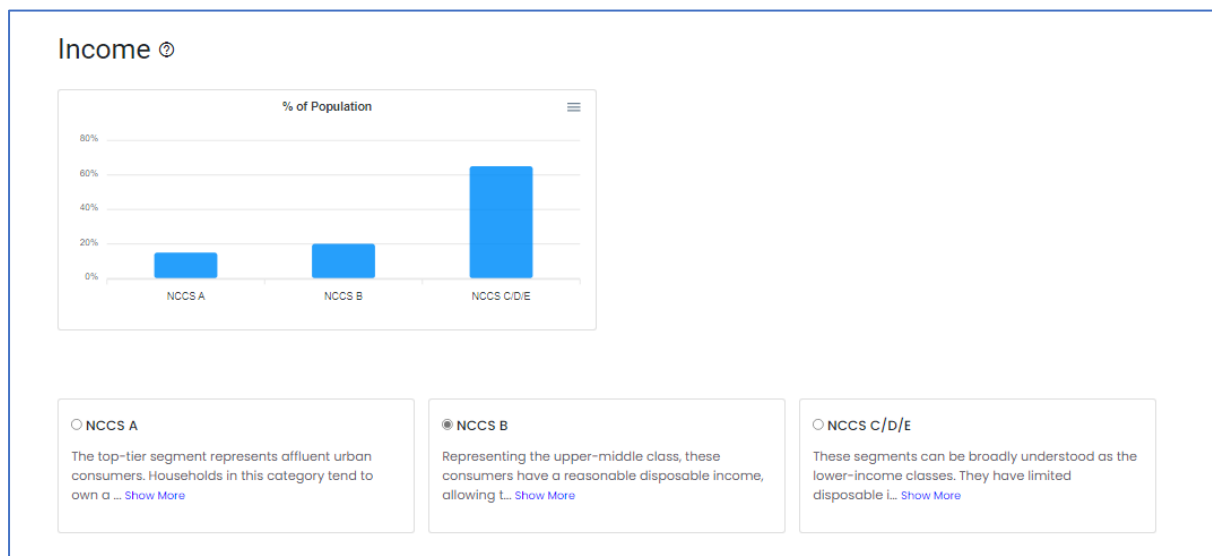
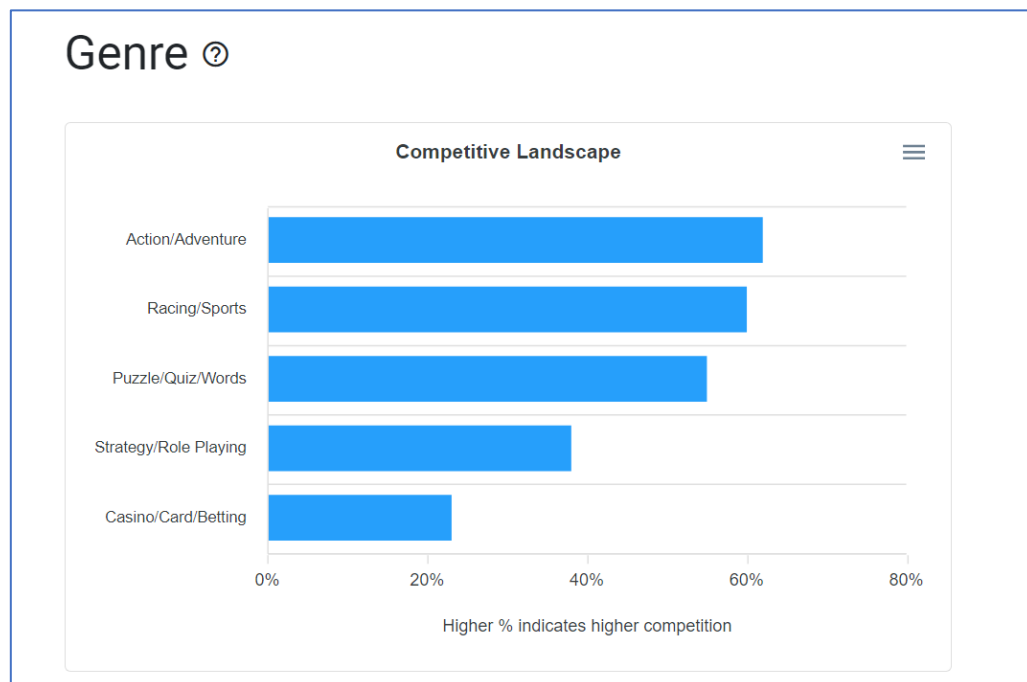


Figure representing Target Market Income Decision area in the simulation

2.2 Stage II - Conceptualizing

a. Product Genre

Selecting the appropriate gaming product genre involves a strategic approach that considers factors such as age group, gender cohort, metro or non -metro preferences, and competition. It's crucial to ensure that the selected genre resonates with the interests of the specified target audience. Conducting a thorough competitive analysis is vital for identifying opportunities and positioning the gaming product effectively.



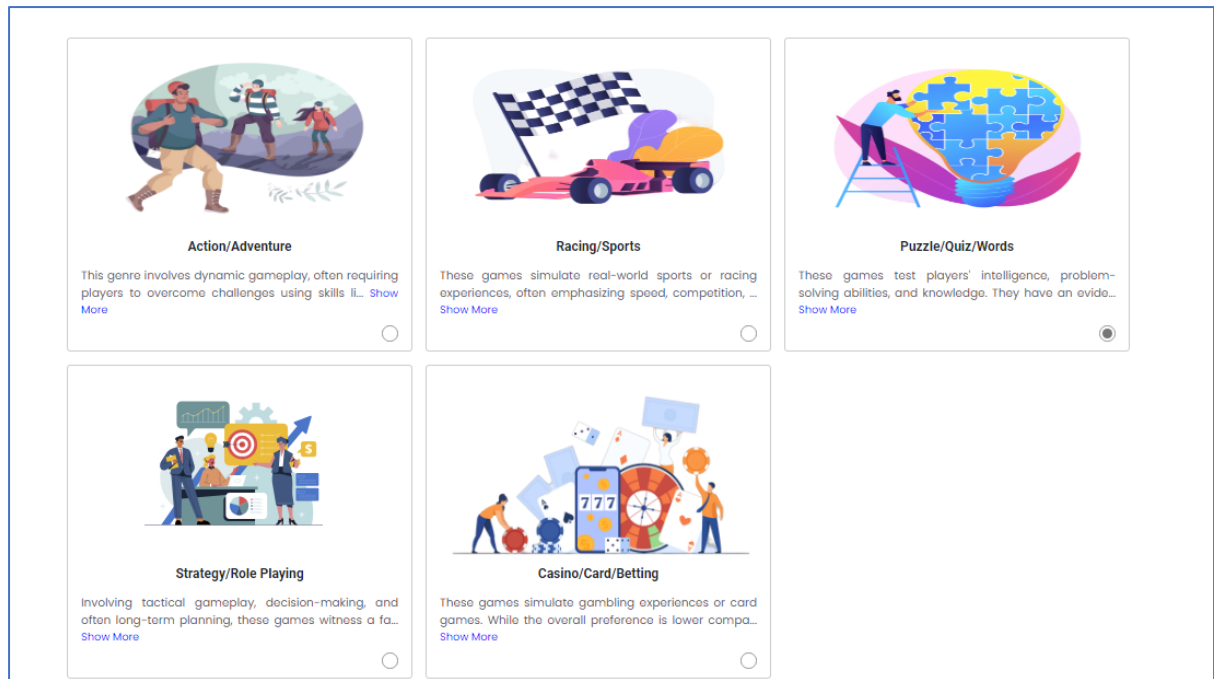


Figure representing game's genre decision area in the simulation

b. Situational Elements

Selecting the correct situational elements for the game, focusing on either gamification, cultural significance, ease of use, or continued motivation to play, is crucial for enhancing immersion and emotional resonance. Opt for two of these elements that align with the preferences of the target market, promoting extended engagement and a heightened sense of immersion in the gaming experience.

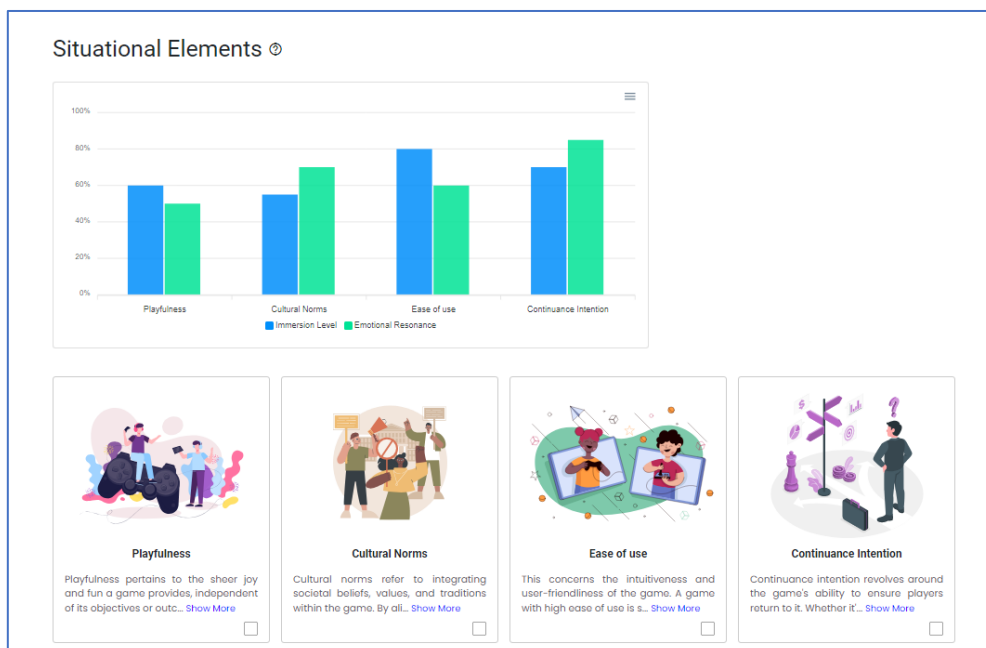


Figure representing game's situational elements decision area in the simulation.

c. Social Elements

Select up to three social features to integrate into the game from options like chat functionality, user trading, leaderboards, push notification feeds, community, and social media integration. Evaluate the impact of each element on consumer engagement and connection. Ensuring a consistently positive user experience is crucial for establishing lasting connections with the audience.

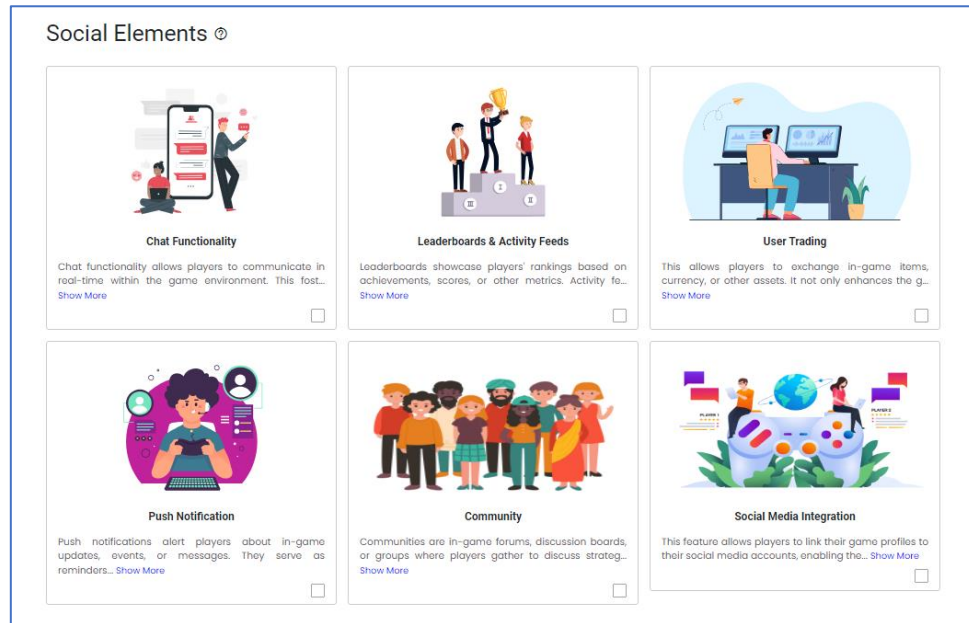


Figure representing game's social elements decision area in the simulation

d. Lifestyle Elements

The selection of lifestyle elements seeks to synchronize the game design with the varied preferences of the target audience, creating a more captivating and personalized interaction within the game. With eight available options, participants are required to choose and integrate a single lifestyle element for the characters or UI/UX of the game. This decision aims to enhance the overall gaming experience by tailoring it to the diverse tastes and preferences of the audience.

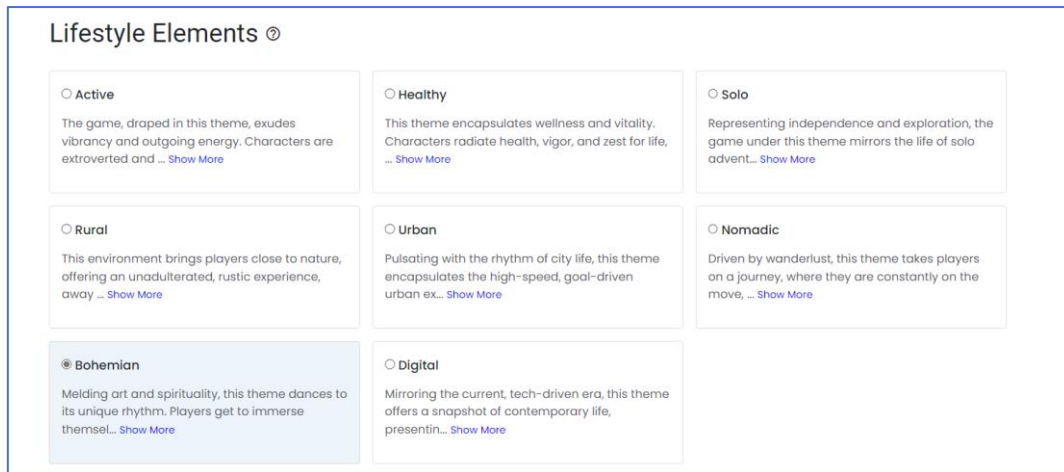


Figure representing game's lifestyle decision area in the simulation.

2.3 Stage III Crafting

a. Communication Strategy

Craft a communication strategy for the game and disseminate it across various channels. The participant can choose up to maximum of three channels. The selected channels should be in harmony with the characteristics of the target market and gaming triggers. Ensure that the strategy takes into account the potential impact on both lifestyle and situational elements, creating a cohesive and tailored approach that resonates effectively with the audience.

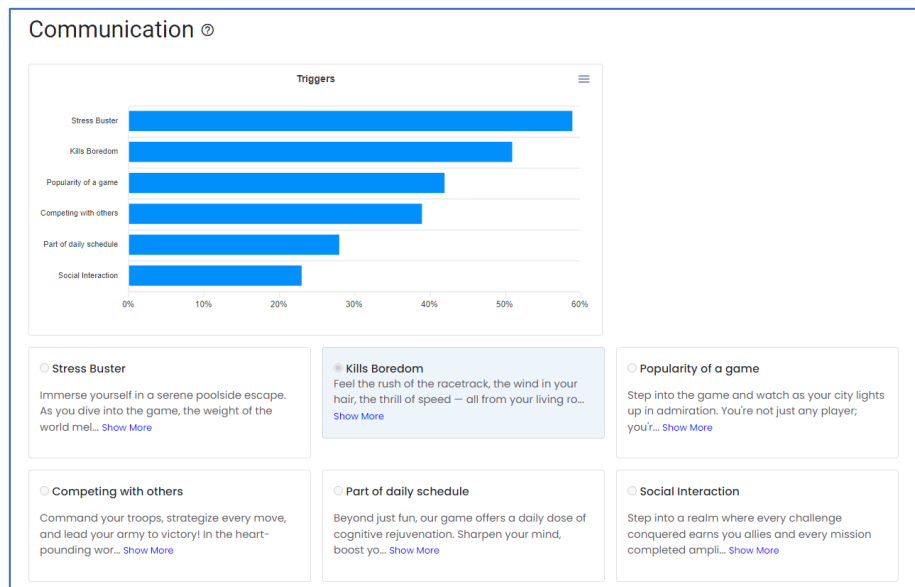


Figure representing communication strategy decision area in the simulation

b. Channel Mix

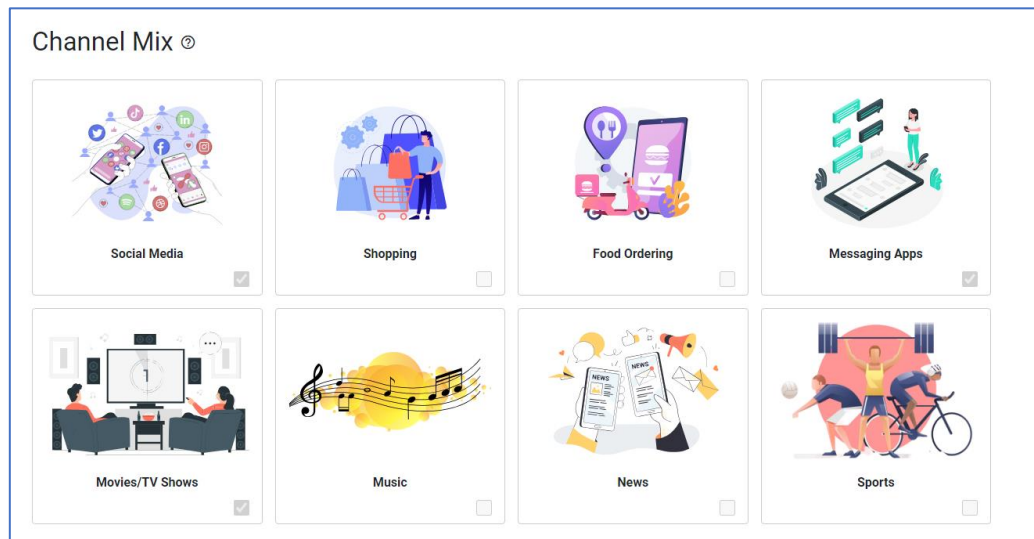


Figure representing Communication Channel Mix decision area in the simulation.

c. Publishing options

The participant faces the decision of either self-publishing the game or opting for a gaming publishing house. Self-publishing offers greater revenue but limited reach, whereas a publisher provides broader reach with revenue sharing. Factors such as revenue sharing, expertise, and the reputation of the publisher should be carefully considered in making this decision.

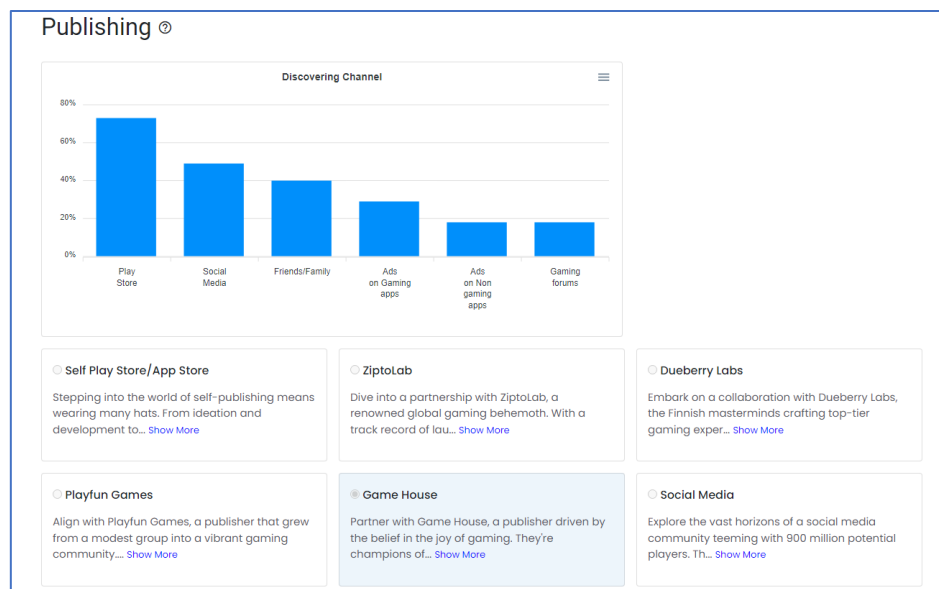


Figure representing game publishing platform decision area in the simulation.

d. Monetization

Generating revenue also involves choosing whether to publish games as free games, freemium games, or pay-to-play games. This decision should be informed by the target audience and their financial capacity, aligning with the goal of attaining substantial revenue for the business.

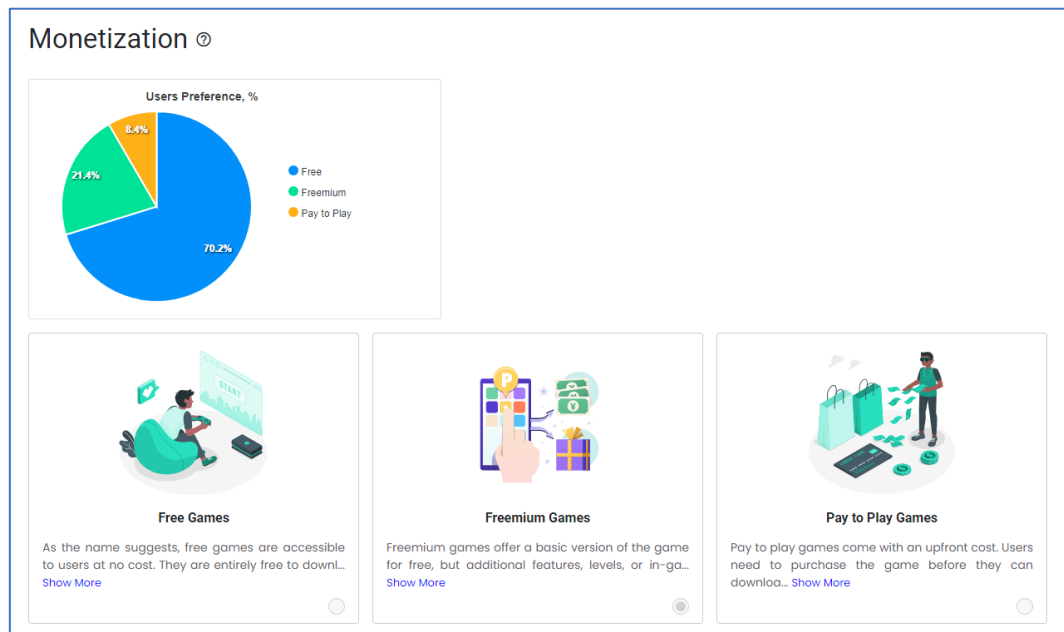


Figure representing game's monetization model decision area in the simulation.

e. In-Game Advertising

Select the optimal method for generating revenue, with a focus on advertisements. Determine the type of ads to be implemented, including options like banner ads, rewarded ads, interstitial ads, interactive ads, or ad networks. When customizing the advertising strategy, it's crucial to align the chosen ad types with the preferences and behaviors of the target market to maximize effectiveness and user satisfaction.

Banner Ads: Banner ads are graphical display ads that typically appear at the top or bottom of a webpage or app screen. Cost-effective, easily noticeable, and can be used for brand awareness. May be less effective for engagement compared to other formats.

Rewarded Ads: Users voluntarily watch ads in exchange for a reward, such as in-app currency, extra lives, or premium content. High engagement as user's opt-in for rewards, providing a positive user experience. Overuse may lead to user fatigue; it's important to balance rewards and ad frequency.

Interstitial Ads: Full-screen ads that appear at natural transition points, like between levels in a game or during app navigation. Captures full attention due to its immersive nature, suitable for promoting products or content. Users may find them intrusive, so timing and relevance are crucial.

Interactive Ads: Ads that allow users to interact with content, often through gamification or mini-tasks. Boosts engagement and user interaction, creating a memorable ad experience. Development may be more complex, and effectiveness depends on the quality of interactivity.

Ad Networks: Connect advertisers with publishers, facilitating the placement of ads across various platforms. Broad reach, efficient targeting, and ease of managing ad campaigns. Ad performance may vary based on the network, and managing relationships with multiple networks can be complex.

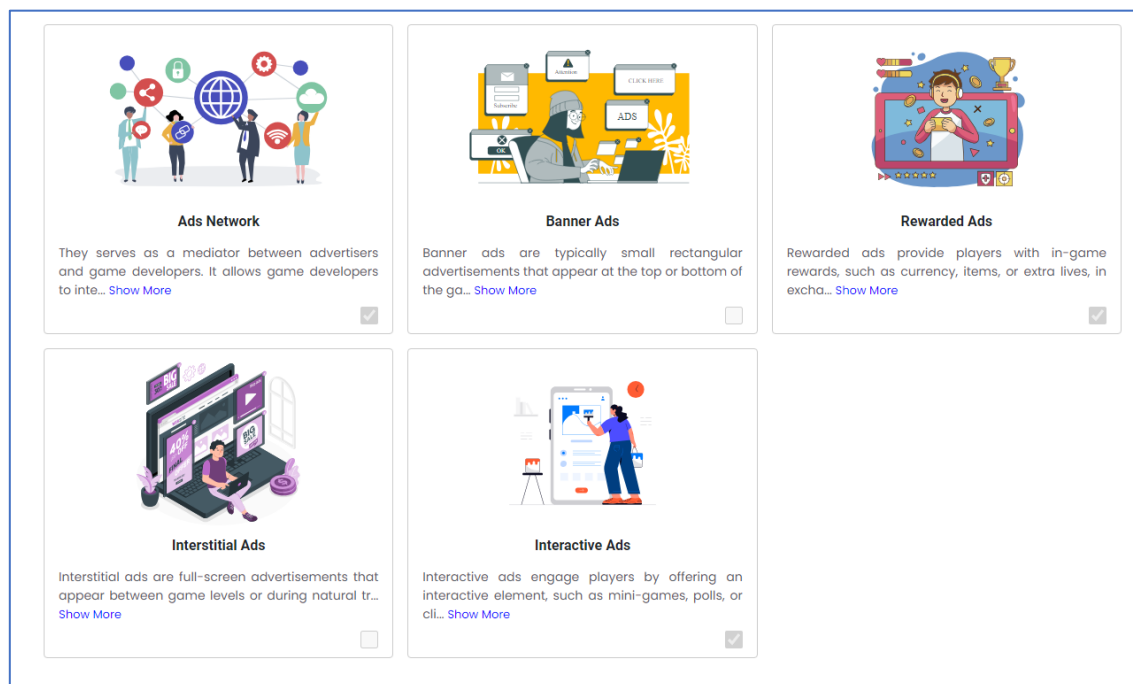


Figure representing advertising channel decision area in the simulation.

2.4 Decision checklist

The decision checklist meticulously outlines the choices made by the participant. If the participant is satisfied with their decisions, they can proceed to the Submit option to save them. It's crucial to note that once decisions are submitted, they cannot be altered. Therefore, participants need to exercise caution and ensure careful consideration before finalizing and submitting their choices.

Decision Checklist

Round 1

Aparna

Target	
Age	25-34yrs
Location	Both
Gender	Male
Income Class	NCCS C/D/E
Language 1	Hindi
Language 2	English
Language 3	Marathi
Language 4	Tamil
Conceptualizing	
Genre	Action/Adventure
Situational Element 1	Cultural Norms
Situational Element 2	Ease of use
Social Element 1	Leaderboards & Activity Feeds
Social Element 2	Community
Social Element 3	Social Media Integration
Lifestyle Element	Bohemian
Crafting	
Communication	Kills Boredom
Channel 1	Social Media
Channel 2	Movies/TV Shows
Channel 3	Messaging Apps
Publishing	Game House
Monetization	Freemium Games
Ads Network	Yes
Banner Ads	No
Rewarded Ads	Yes
Interstitial Ads	No
Interactive Ads	Yes

Submit

Figure Showing the Decision Checklist section in the Simulation

2.5 Report



Figure Showing the report section in the Simulation

The report section consists of detailed information on how well the participant took the overall decision in designing the product. This section consists of feedback on the performance of the participant based on four metrics.

- **Rigour:** Consistency throughout the decision-making and recommendation.
- **Structuring:** Logical approach of gathering and analysing information
- **Synthesis:** Approach towards interpreting information and making informed decisions
- **Business Judgement:** Ability to evaluate facts and consider risks and possible implications when making decisions.

Examine the specifics outlined in the report, encompassing target demographics, conceptualization elements, monetization, and communication decisions. These choices directly influence the attainment of market share and the count of paying consumers. It is crucial to meet the market share goal of surpassing 7% to positively leverage network externality effects.

2.6 Synopsis

The synopsis section provides a summarized overview of the decision areas, highlighting the effectiveness of your critical thinking abilities in each aspect. It includes information that showcase the extent to which your thought process contributed to the outcomes in each area. This concise presentation offers insights into the impact of your decision-making skills on various aspects of the scenario.

Round 1 XLS

Synopsis

Decisions	
Age	25-34yrs
Location	Both
Gender	Male
Income Class	NCCS C/D/E
Language 1	Hindi
Language 2	English
Language 3	Marathi
Language 4	Tamil
Genre	Action/Adventure
Situational Element 1	Cultural Norms
Situational Element 2	Ease of use
Social Element 1	Leaderboards & Activity Feeds
Social Element 2	Community
Social Element 3	Social Media integration
Lifestyle Element	Bohemian
Communication	Kills Boredom
Channel 1	Social Media
Channel 2	Movies/TV Shows
Channel 3	Messaging Apps
Publishing	Game House
Monetization	Freemium Games

Market %	
Market Share	5.5
Paying Customers	0.3

Market Units, mn	
Number of users	20 mn
Number of paying customers	0.05 mn

Thinking Ability, %	
Target	100
Conceptualizing	50
Crafting	80

Figure Showing the Synopsis section in the Simulation